Benevolent House
Practice Case: Malik, First 90-Day Review

Purpose: practice material for the Licensed Therapist Orientation. Malik, the Whitfields, and every detail here are fictional.

Child and placement

Item	Detail
Child	Malik, age 11 (fictional)
Caregivers	Karen and Tom Whitfield, credentialed for Basic and Mental & Behavioral Health
Service Package	Mental & Behavioral Health Support Services
Case manager	Ms. Ortiz
Time in placement	About 12 weeks at this review
Therapy	Weekly individual therapy through STAR Health with a community therapist. Attended 10 of 12 sessions; 2 missed for illness. No family sessions yet.

CANS 3.0 summary (most recent, completed for this review)

Actionable needs: Anger Control; Adjustment to Trauma. Items to monitor: Attachment Difficulties; School Behavior. Useful strengths: Interpersonal skills with adults he trusts; Talents and Interests (building models, drawing). No suicide risk indicated on the screener.

Priority problem (agreed by the support team at week 6)

"When Malik is told without warning that time is up, at home or at school, he responds by throwing or tearing things and leaving the room, and what helps is a five-minute warning, a named stopping point, and an adult who tells him calmly that he is not in trouble for being upset."

Moment-by-moment assessments

Episode	Just before	During	After
Sunday, week 5, 6:40 PM, living room	Relaxed, deep in a video game. Tom says game time is over, now. No warning.	Throws controller, punches wall, runs to backyard.	Back in 25 minutes, quiet. Asks, "Do I still live here?"
Thursday, week 6, school	Calm, working on a timed test. Teacher calls time.	Tears paper, walks out, found in the bathroom after 15 minutes.	Back in class calm, no more work. At home asks Karen, "Am I in trouble?"

Serious incident, week 7

A scheduled phone call from Malik's mother did not happen. Around 9:30 PM Malik left through his bedroom window. Tom found him about an hour later on a neighbor's porch, unhurt. Reported as Minimum Standards require. The case manager completed a moment-by-moment review with the caregivers the next day. Malik said afterward: "She forgot me again. I figured you'd send me back anyway."

Managing Emotions Guide (excerpt, Malik's words)

Stage	What flips my switch / what I feel	Things I can do	Things an adult can help with
Revving	"When someone says time's up out of nowhere." "My chest gets hot and my hands make fists."	Go to my spot by the fence. Squeeze my stress ball.	Give me five minutes. Tell me I'm not leaving.
Re-experiencing	"I can't hear anybody. I just want out."	(not yet written)	Don't grab me. Stay where I can see you.
Reconstituting	"I feel stupid after."	Draw. Get water.	Don't make me talk right away.

Current safety and crisis plan (written at placement, before the incident)

Warning signs: clenched fists, pacing. If upset: give space, call the on-call line if needed. Call 911 for an emergency. Shared with caregivers and on-call staff.

Service Plan goals and progress

Goal	Progress this period
Child: Malik will use his spot or ask for help when revving, in 3 of 4 episodes.	Used his spot in 1 of 3 episodes. Asked for help once.
Environment: Caregivers will give a five-minute warning before every screen-time and bedtime transition.	Started week 6. Karen reports about 80 percent of transitions; Tom is still building the habit.
Environment: The team will plan for missed or cancelled family calls.	Not yet planned. Raised after the week 7 incident.

Practice exercises

Exercise A (Chapter 4). Using the moment-by-moment assessments, the incident, and the guide, draft the revving and re-experiencing sections of Malik's updated safety and crisis plan: the warning signs, what each adult does, and when the caregivers call for help.

Exercise B (Chapter 5). Write your input for this review: the type and frequency of therapy, with the justification; whether the treatment target lines up with the priority problem; caregiver participation; any risk the safety plan does not cover; and anything that could get in the way of services.